



# Taylor Star

HIRED SANTA

*Ho, ho... who?*

FOR TAYLOR STAR'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

## WHO YOU ARE

An actor hired to play Santa tonight. You've been by the tree all evening, handing out presents.

## COSTUME

**Easy:** Santa suit, or an elf costume.

**Go all out:** the full Santa suit with a fluffy beard, or a velvet elf costume with striped stockings and a bell.

## PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Morgan Ivy:** booked you for the party
- **Charlie Bell:** keeps asking you to pose for photos
- **Everyone else:** you've only just met them, ho ho

## WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Stay in character as Santa all night
- Hear every bit of gossip in the room
- Find out who's been naughty, and who's been nice

## THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

## YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

### 1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

### 2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

### 3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

### 4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES



# Before the game

You're an actor hired to play Santa tonight. You've been beside the tree all evening.

## YOUR SECRET

A MegaMart executive paid you \$200 to report any gossip from the party. You've been texting them all night.

## You are innocent

## HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

## Playing Taylor



**Your manner:** Jolly, theatrical and nosy. Stay in Santa (or elf) character as long as you can: ho-ho-ho, ask who's been naughty, and keep sneaking looks at your phone.

### LINES TO TRY

- "Ho, ho... who's been naughty tonight?"
- "Santa sees everything from beside the tree."
- "Sorry, just checking on the reindeer."  
(Check your phone.)

### IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Stay in character: "Santa? A poisoner? On Christmas Eve? Ho, ho, no!"

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

# Rounds 1 & 2



## Round 1



*Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1*

**Play it like this:** Stay jolly. Admit you were by the tree from 6:30.

### REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Lots of gifts arrived under the tree between 6:30 and 7:00.
- Gossip: when you asked Nick what he wanted for Christmas, he said "a quiet retirement".

### QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Morgan who booked Santa, and why.
- Ask Alex what they shouted at Nick at about 8:00. You heard it from the tree.

### MINI TASK

In character as Santa, ask three people what they want for Christmas. Note any answer that sounds like a motive.

## Round 2



*Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2*

**Play it like this:** Share what you saw: at about 6:45, while you were adjusting your beard, someone in a **green workshop apron** slipped a small box with a red velvet ribbon under the tree.

### REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- The box was small, about the size of a bottle.
- You remember the ribbon clearly: red velvet, tied in a neat bow.

### QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Morgan which gifts under the tree were for Nick.
- Ask Jamie whether Nick had a sweet tooth.

### MINI TASK

Give a "naughty or nice" verdict on two suspects, and explain why.

### CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- |                                          |                                        |                                       |                                         |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Robin Holly     | <input type="checkbox"/> Jordan Tinsel | <input type="checkbox"/> Sam Garland  | <input type="checkbox"/> Casey Sleigh   |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Alex Snow       | <input type="checkbox"/> Morgan Ivy    | <input type="checkbox"/> Charlie Bell | <input type="checkbox"/> Frankie Fir    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Quinn Mistletoe | <input type="checkbox"/> Jamie Pudding | <input type="checkbox"/> Riley Carol  | <input type="checkbox"/> Inspector Noel |

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# Round 3 & notes



## Round 3



*Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3*

**Play it like this:** Confess the MegaMart texts if pressed. They show that MegaMart wanted the deal to go through, and a dead Nick puts it at risk.

### REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- MegaMart wanted the sale to go through. Nick dead puts it at risk.
- You keep checking your phone. Somebody will notice.

### QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan what the sale means now that Nick is gone.
- Ask Quinn whether the press already knew about MegaMart.

### MINI TASK

Before ballots, read out "Santa's list": who has been naughty tonight (not necessarily the culprit).

### BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

### NOTES

## Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker  
 Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece  
 Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker  
 Taylor Star · Hired Santa  
 Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener  
 Jamie Pudding · Village Baker  
 Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director  
 Casey Sleigh · Caterer  
 Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant  
 Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager  
 Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist  
 Riley Carol · Hired Pianist  
 Nick Frost · the victim